

FULL-DAY EMERGENCY SUB PLANS
KINDERGARTEN • VOLUME 1

THREE WHOLE DAYS

3
FULL DAYS

Ready-to-go kindergarten plans for those last-minute cover days — **just print and teach.**

Built around a read-aloud,
for children who cannot read yet.



FULL DAY



READ-ALoud



PICTURE-LED

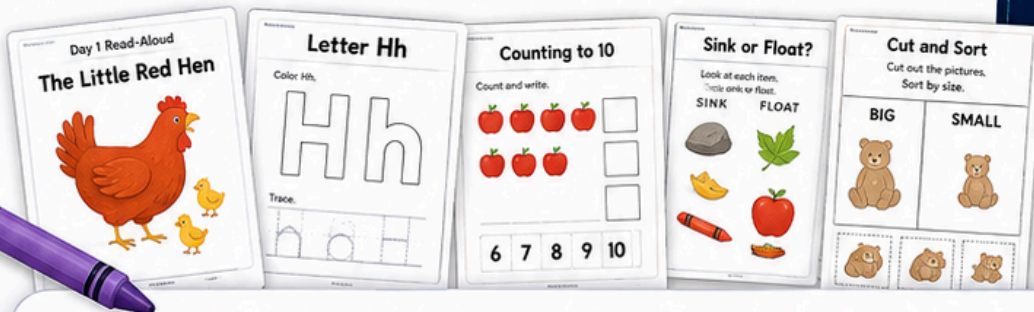


NO PREP

- ✓ Three complete school days, arrival to dismissal
- ✓ A read-aloud story every day, printed in full for the sub
- ✓ Letters, writing, math and science every day
- ✓ Every student page is picture-led, with one task on it
- ✓ Tracing rails, drawing space and cut-and-sort tasks

★ Perfect for busy teachers and last-minute subs

Everything you need to walk in and teach **with confidence.**



READING

Read-aloud stories build comprehension and vocabulary.



LETTERS

Letter recognition, writing and phonics every day.



MATH

Counting, numbers and simple concepts made visual.



SCIENCE

Hands-on thinking and real-world exploration.



DIGITAL VECTOR



Kindergarten



62 pages



digitalvector.com.au

How This Pack Works

START HERE

Most sub plans hand a substitute a worksheet. In kindergarten that fails before the worksheet reaches the table, because the children cannot read the instructions, cannot work alone, and have not got the pencil control the sheet assumes.

This pack is built the way a kindergarten day actually runs. A read-aloud on the carpet. Blocks of fifteen to twenty minutes. A movement break between almost all of them. And student pages that carry one task each, told in pictures.

What is different about a kindergarten pack

WHY IT MATTERS	
The adult talks constantly	Eight pages a day are for the substitute and eight are for the children. That is the correct way round at this age.
One task per page	Never two. A kindergarten child who finishes half a page has done the whole task, not half of it.
Pictures, not instructions	Every student page can be understood by a child who cannot read a word, because the pictures say what to do.
Tracing before writing	Rails with a dashed midline, letters at forty points, and a name line on every morning page.
Cut and sort, not fill in	The afternoon task is physical. Scissors and glue hold attention that a pencil will not.

SIXTEEN PAGES PER DAY. EIGHT TO COPY, EIGHT TO KEEP.

Copy each day as one stapled packet and hand it out in the morning.

The substitute keeps the Day at a Glance page, the carpet script, the read-aloud story, the three teaching scripts and the What to Look For page.

Will a substitute cope with this?

That is the question the pack is built to answer. Every block the substitute leads has the words to say printed out. The read-aloud has the whole story and the questions. The letter, math and afternoon blocks each have a script that says what to say, what to hold up, and what to do when a child cannot do it. There is a page on holding a kindergarten class you have never met, and a bank of things to do when a gap opens up. None of it assumes early years training.



Substitute Quick Start

FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

If you have five minutes before the children arrive, read this page and nothing else.

IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

1. Find the Day at a Glance page. Put it on the desk and leave it.
2. Check the packets are copied. If not, copy the Morning Work page first and the rest while they work.
3. Write your name on the board and draw a small picture next to it. They will use the picture, not the name.
4. Read the carpet script. Do not improvise the first minute.
5. Skim the story so you are not seeing it for the first time in front of them.

The shape of every day in this pack

ROUGHLY	WHAT HAPPENS
Arrival	Morning work at tables. Tracing and coloring. You take attendance while they work.
Carpet	Ten minutes. Introduce yourself, teach the quiet signal, say what happens before recess.
Read aloud	Fifteen minutes on the carpet, then talking, then drawing at tables.
Morning blocks	Letters, then writing, then math. A movement break between each one.
Afternoon	Rest time, then the science block read aloud together, then cut and sort.
Last ten minutes	The How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.

THREE THINGS THAT MATTER MORE THAN THE LESSONS

Say what is next before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down." They are not being difficult at transitions. They do not know what is coming.

Ask them to show you the routines. Where they line up, how they hand things in, who sits where. They know, they love telling you, and it makes them your allies.

Praise out loud, correct quietly. Naming a child who is doing the right thing moves a whole room.



The Three Days

THE THREE DAYS

Each day is completely independent. Leave them in any order. No day assumes anything from another.

DAY	STORY	LETTER	MATH	AFTERNOON
1	Sam the Snail Is Slow	Ss	Counting to Five	How Animals Move
2	The Moon Came to Tea	Mm	Shapes All Around	Day and Night
3	Ten Tiny Turtles	Tt	Counting to Ten	What Living Things Need

The read-aloud stories

DAY	THE STORY	WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT
1	Sam the Snail Is Slow	A snail is last in every race, until the day being slow is the only reason anybody finds the strawberry.
2	The Moon Came to Tea	A girl invites the moon to tea. The moon cannot come down, so the tea goes outside instead.
3	Ten Tiny Turtles	Ten eggs hatch on the sand and nine turtles find the sea. The tenth one goes the wrong way, and then the moon comes out.

WHICH DAY SHOULD I LEAVE?

A class you do not know at all: Day 1. The story is the gentlest and the counting only goes to five.

You want work you can look at when you return: Day 3. The counting page shows you instantly who has one to one correspondence.

A restless group, or a Friday: Day 2. The shape hunt gets them up and moving with a purpose.

A NOTE ON THE READ-ALOUD

The full text of each story is printed on the substitute page, with three marked places to stop and ask a question. At this age the story is the biggest teaching block of the morning, not a warm-up.

Read it slowly. Take two or three answers at each stop and then carry on, however many hands are still up.

Class Information

TEACHER • FILL THIS IN ONCE AT THE START OF THE YEAR

Complete this once and it works for every absence after. A kindergarten substitute needs far more of this than an older grade does.

THE BASICS

My name and grade

Room number

Teach this day

Day ____ or any day from the index

Teacher next door

Office extension

Teaching assistant

THE DAY

Bell times

Recess and lunch

Rest time

How long, and do they lie down?

Bathroom routine

Alone, in pairs, or as a class?

Where the class lines up

Carpet spots

THE CHILDREN

Collected by an adult?

Who, and any custody notes

Medical, allergies, medication

Toileting and spare clothes

Children who find change hard

Children who can help you

Holding a Kindergarten Class

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

FIVE YEAR OLDS ARE NOT TESTING YOU ON PURPOSE

They are finding out what the rules are with a new adult, which is a sensible thing for a small person to do. Being warm and completely predictable settles a room faster than being strict.

Say this instead of that

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three parts.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise whoever does.
"Hurry up."	"I am counting to ten and then we are going." Then count. Out loud. Slowly.
"You should know this."	"Let me show you again." They might genuinely not know, and being told off stops them asking.

Six moves that work in any kindergarten room

- Teach a clap-back signal in the first ten minutes. You clap, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm.
- Count down instead of asking twice. "Pencils down in five, four, three." It moves a room faster than any instruction.
- Narrate what is going right. "Table two is ready." The rest copy within seconds and nobody has been told off.
- Give the busiest child a job. Handing out packets, holding the door, line leader. Redirection, not reward.
- Get them up every fifteen minutes. Fidgeting at this age is a signal, not misbehavior.
- Sit down on the carpet with them for the story. Standing over a group of five year olds makes them wriggle.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES PROPERLY WRONG

If a child is hurt, distressed, or a situation is beyond a normal classroom problem, send two children to the office or the teacher next door. Do not leave the class, and do not try to handle it alone because you want to seem capable.

Crying is common at this age and usually passes. Kneel down to their height, say what happens next, and give it two minutes before deciding it is serious.

What Is on Every Page

EVERY PAGE IN THIS PACK

Eight pages per day are copied for the children. Eight are kept by the substitute, because at this age the adult needs more paper than the class does.

PAGE	WHAT IT IS	CONTENTS
1-7	Getting started	Cover, how the pack works, quick start, the three days, class information, holding a kindergarten class, this page
8-15	Day 1 scripts	Day at a Glance, carpet script, the full story, and three teaching scripts. Substitute keeps these.
16-23	Day 1 student pages	Morning work, after the story, Ss, writing, two math pages, the cut and sort, and How Was Today? Eight pages to copy.
24-31	Day 2 scripts	Day at a Glance, carpet script, the full story, and three teaching scripts. Substitute keeps these.
32-39	Day 2 student pages	Morning work, after the story, Mm, writing, two math pages, the cut and sort, and How Was Today? Eight pages to copy.
40-47	Day 3 scripts	Day at a Glance, carpet script, the full story, and three teaching scripts. Substitute keeps these.
48-55	Day 3 student pages	Morning work, after the story, Tt, writing, two math pages, the cut and sort, and How Was Today? Eight pages to copy.
56-60	The filler banks	Time fillers, brain breaks, wet weather games, a choosing time menu and the substitute note back
61-62	Reference	Standards alignment, terms of use and credits

THE FASTEST WAY TO USE THIS PACK

Photocopy the eight student pages for one day as a single stapled packet. Put the eight substitute pages on the desk in order. That is the whole preparation.

Day 1 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school bells win. The Page column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. Nothing here runs past twenty, and there is a movement break between almost all of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they trace.	p. 16
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	The story, on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	Talk about it	Turn and talk, then the drawing page at desks.	p. 17
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:50	Letters	Teach the sound, then the tracing page.	p. 18
10:15	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:40	Writing	Draw first, then one word underneath.	p. 19
11:05	Break	Two minutes. They will need it.	back
11:15	Math	Teaching script together, then the two pages.	p. 20
11:55	Lunch	Line them up five minutes early.	—
12:45	Rest time	Books, heads down, or the quiet bank.	back
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud, then the cut and sort.	p. 22
1:50	Choosing time	If there is no special, use the Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 23
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut choosing time and the second math page first. Never cut the movement breaks or the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. They are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everybody. My name is on the board, and I have drawn a little picture next to it so you can find it.

Your teacher is away today and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing.

First, my quiet signal. I clap like this, and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely.

This morning we have a story about a snail who is very, very slow, some letters, and some counting. This afternoon we find out how animals move.

You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write your name on the board and draw a small picture beside it. They will remember the picture.
- 2 Teach the clap-back signal. Practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
- 3 Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
- 4 Ask: what does this class always do at carpet time? Take two answers only.
- 5 Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
- 6 Start the story while they are still settled.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.

Read Aloud: Sam the Snail Is Slow

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The orange boxes are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

Sam the Snail Is Slow

Read-aloud story

Sam was a snail, and Sam was slow.

He was the slowest thing in the whole garden. He was slower than the ant. He was slower than the beetle. He was slower than the rain running down a leaf.

One morning the beetle said, "We are having a race. To the far wall and back. You can watch, Sam."

STOP AND ASK

What do you think Sam will say?

"I will race," said Sam.

Everybody laughed. Not in a mean way. They just could not help it.

"Go!" said the beetle, and off they went.

The beetle went fast. Then the beetle found a crumb, and stopped.

The ant went fast. Then the ant found a smell she liked, and stopped.

The butterfly went fastest of all. Then the butterfly found a flower, and stopped.

STOP AND ASK

Why do you think the others all stopped?

Sam did not go fast. But Sam did not stop.

He went past the crumb. He went past the smell. He went past the flower. And halfway along, under a big green leaf where nobody had thought to look, Sam found a strawberry.

It was the reddest strawberry in the garden.

Sam did not eat it. He went all the way back, slowly, and told everybody. And they all sat under the leaf together and ate it.

The beetle won the race. Sam did not mind at all.

STOP AND ASK

What did Sam see that nobody else saw?



Talking About the Story

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Five minutes on the carpet, then send them to tables for the drawing page. Kindergarten comprehension is spoken, not written, so this is where you find out whether the story landed.

Turn and talk, twice

SAY THIS

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them the part you liked best. I will count to twenty and then I want to hear two of them.

Now tell them one thing that happened at the beginning, and one thing that happened at the end.

What to listen for

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Retells one thing that actually happened in the story	Retells a different story, or tells you their own news
Uses a character name	Says "the one" or "him" for everybody
Answers the question that was asked	Answers a question nobody asked, which is very normal at five

The answers you are listening for

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE	
Question 1	Open. Most children will say Sam cannot race. A few will say he will try. Both are good.
Question 2	Look for the idea that they all stopped for something. You do not need the word distracted.
Question 3	The strawberry. Then ask why only Sam saw it. That is the whole story, and some children will get there.

THEN SEND THEM TO TABLES

The drawing page comes next. Say it before you move: "Draw the part you liked best. One picture. You do not have to write anything."

A child who draws something not in the story has still listened. Ask them about it before you decide otherwise.

Teaching Ss

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Today our sound is Ss. Watch my mouth. sss.

Now you. sss. Again, longer. sss.

Put your hand in front of your mouth and say it again. Can you feel it?

Now I am going to say some words. Put your thumb up if the word starts with sss.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write the letter big on the board, capital and small. Say the sound each time, not the letter name.
- 2 Say the words on the student page out loud, one at a time. Thumbs up or thumbs down.
- 3 Hand out the page. Point at the tracing rail and trace one in the air together first.
- 4 They trace, then circle the pictures. Say the picture names out loud as they work, because some will not know them.

THE SOUND, NOT THE NAME

Say sss, not the letter name. At this age the sound is what lets them read; the name comes later and gets in the way now.

If a child is stuck

THEY CANNOT	DO THIS
Hear the sound	Say the word slowly and stretch the first sound. Stretch it far longer than feels sensible.
Form the letter	Trace it on their back with your finger, then let them trace it on the table, then on paper.
Name the picture	Tell them. It is a vocabulary gap, not a phonics one, and guessing wastes the block.



Teaching Counting to Five

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Hold up your fingers and count with me. One, two, three, four, five.

Now I am going to count some things on the board, and I want you to catch me if I get it wrong.

Count them slowly, touching each one. Then count the same group again but deliberately count one twice, and let them catch you.

That is the whole lesson. When you count, you touch each thing once. One touch, one number.

The thing you are actually teaching

ONE TOUCH, ONE NUMBER

The skill is one to one correspondence: touching each object exactly once as you say each number. A child who chants to ten perfectly but double counts the objects has not got it yet, and that child is the reason this block exists.

What good looks like

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Counts and touches each one once	Says numbers faster than the finger moves, or skips one
Says the last number when asked how many	Recounts from one every time you ask
Writes the number, even wobbly or backwards	Cannot start. Trace it with them once, then let go.

TWO PAGES, IN ORDER

The first math page is done together, out loud. The second is theirs to do at the table. If the block is running long, stop after the first page. Half of it done properly is worth more than both rushed.

Science: How Animals Move

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each one before you move on. This is a talking block, not a writing block.

1. Animals do not all move the same way. Some walk. Some hop. Some fly. Some swim. And some, like Sam, crawl along on their tummy.

Ask: show me how a bird moves. Now show me how a snail moves.

2. An animal moves the way its body is built. A bird has wings, so it flies. A fish has fins, so it swims. A snail has one big foot underneath, so it slides.

Ask: why do you think a snail cannot hop?

3. Moving slowly is not the same as being bad at moving. Sam gets everywhere he needs to go. He just sees more on the way.

Ask: can you think of another animal that is slow?

4. Some animals move in more than one way. A duck can walk and swim and fly, all in the same afternoon.

Ask: can you think of an animal that does two things?

THEN THE CUT AND SORT

Hand out the sorting page. Cut first, all of them, before anybody glues anything. Then sort. Then glue.

Crawl: the snail and the snake. Fly: the bird. The fish is the argument, because it does neither. Take swims as a third answer and praise the child who says it.

What to Look For

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Kindergarten work does not mark like older work. Most of these pages have no right answer, so this page tells you what to look at instead, and what to write on the note back.

The pages with actual answers

PAGE	ANSWER
Letters: Ss	Circle: sun, sock, star, snake, snail. Not circled: cat, moon, tree.
Math: counting	Ten frames show 3, 5 and 2. On the second page any drawing that matches the number is correct, however wobbly the circles are.
Afternoon sort	Crawl: the snail and the snake. Fly: the bird. The fish is the argument, because it does neither. Take swims as a third answer and praise the child who says it.

The pages with no right answer

PAGE	WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING AT
Morning work	Did they find their name line and have a go? Tracing quality is not the point on a day with a stranger in the room.
After the story	Does the picture come from the story? Ask them about it before deciding it does not.
Writing	One letter is a success. The initial sound is a big success. A whole word is a bonus, not the target.
How Was Today?	The most useful page in the pile. Read these first and leave them on top.

DO NOT CORRECT THE LETTER FORMATION

Backwards letters are developmentally normal at five and stay normal for a while yet. Correcting them in front of a substitute teaches a child that writing is dangerous. Leave it for the class teacher.

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Morning Work

Name: _____

1 Write your name at the top.

2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.

3 Color the picture.

1. Trace and say

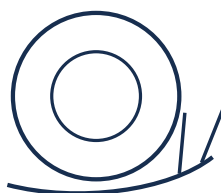
sun

sit

see

2. Color me

COLOR THE PICTURE FROM TODAY'S STORY



After the Story

1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Tell somebody about your picture.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



My picture

TALK ABOUT IT

Tell the person next to you what is happening in your picture.

Letter of the Day: Ss

1 Trace the letters.

2 Circle the pictures that start with the sound.

S s S s S s

Circle the ones that start with sss



sun



cat



sock



star



snake



moon



snail



tree

FINISHED?

Find one more thing in this room that starts with sss. Draw it on the back of your sheet.

Draw and Label

1 Draw one thing from the story.

2 Write the first letter underneath.

YOUR PICTURE



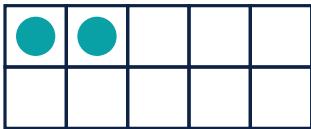
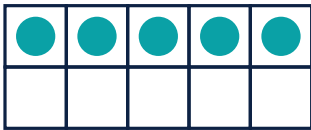
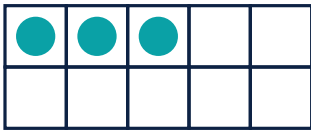
What did you draw?

FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

One letter is a success here. If a child writes the first sound of their word, that is exactly where kindergarten writing should be. Do not ask for more, and do not correct what they do write.

Counting to Five

- 1 Count the circles out loud.
- 2 Touch each one as you say the number.
- 3 Write how many in the box.



Your Turn

1 Trace the numbers.

2 Draw that many circles in the box.

1

2

3

4

5

1

2

3



How Animals Move: Cut and Sort

1 Cut out the four pictures at the bottom.

2 Put each one in the right box.

3 Glue them down when you are sure.

THINGS THAT CRAWL

THINGS THAT FLY



snail



snake



bird



fish

FINISHED?

Draw one more thing that would go in either box.

How Was Today?

1 Color the face that shows how today felt.

2 Draw one thing you did today.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name

Day 2 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school bells win. The Page column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. Nothing here runs past twenty, and there is a movement break between almost all of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they trace.	p. 32
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	The story, on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	Talk about it	Turn and talk, then the drawing page at desks.	p. 33
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:50	Letters	Teach the sound, then the tracing page.	p. 34
10:15	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:40	Writing	Draw first, then one word underneath.	p. 35
11:05	Break	Two minutes. They will need it.	back
11:15	Math	Teaching script together, then the two pages.	p. 36
11:55	Lunch	Line them up five minutes early.	—
12:45	Rest time	Books, heads down, or the quiet bank.	back
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud, then the cut and sort.	p. 38
1:50	Choosing time	If there is no special, use the Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 39
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut choosing time and the second math page first. Never cut the movement breaks or the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. They are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everybody. My name is on the board, and I have drawn a little picture next to it so you can find it.

Your teacher is away today and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing.

First, my quiet signal. I clap like this, and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely.

This morning we have a story about a girl who asked the moon to tea, some letters, and some shapes. This afternoon we sort out day and night.

You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write your name on the board and draw a small picture beside it. They will remember the picture.
- 2 Teach the clap-back signal. Practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
- 3 Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
- 4 Ask: what does this class always do at carpet time? Take two answers only.
- 5 Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
- 6 Start the story while they are still settled.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.

Read Aloud: The Moon Came to Tea

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The orange boxes are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Moon Came to Tea

Read-aloud story

Nell made a card. It said COME TO TEA, and she drew a cup on it, and she put it on the windowsill for the moon.

STOP AND ASK

Do you think the moon will come?

At four o'clock she put out two cups. One big, one small.

The moon did not come.

At five o'clock she opened the door, in case the moon was shy.

The moon did not come.

At six o'clock she went and stood right under the window and said, quite loudly, "The tea is going cold."

The moon stayed exactly where it was.

STOP AND ASK

What else could Nell try?

Nell went to find her dad. "The moon will not come to tea," she said.

"No," said Dad. "The moon cannot come down. The moon has to stay up there. That is its job."

Nell thought about that for a long time.

Then she picked up the tray, and she carried it outside, and she put it down on the step.

And there was the moon, right in the middle of her cup, shining on the tea.

"There you are," said Nell.

STOP AND ASK

How did the moon come to tea in the end?



Talking About the Story

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Five minutes on the carpet, then send them to tables for the drawing page. Kindergarten comprehension is spoken, not written, so this is where you find out whether the story landed.

Turn and talk, twice

SAY THIS

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them the part you liked best. I will count to twenty and then I want to hear two of them.

Now tell them one thing that happened at the beginning, and one thing that happened at the end.

What to listen for

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Retells one thing that actually happened in the story	Retells a different story, or tells you their own news
Uses a character name	Says "the one" or "him" for everybody
Answers the question that was asked	Answers a question nobody asked, which is very normal at five

The answers you are listening for

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE	
Question 1	Open. Take yes and no. Ask one child why.
Question 2	Any idea at all. This is a brainstorm and it should be quick.
Question 3	She went outside to the moon. If a child says the moon was in the cup, that is the reflection, and it is worth saying out loud.

THEN SEND THEM TO TABLES

The drawing page comes next. Say it before you move: "Draw the part you liked best. One picture. You do not have to write anything."

A child who draws something not in the story has still listened. Ask them about it before you decide otherwise.

Teaching Mm

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Today our sound is Mm. Watch my mouth. mmm.

Now you. mmm. Again, longer. mmm.

Put your hand in front of your mouth and say it again. Can you feel it?

Now I am going to say some words. Put your thumb up if the word starts with mmm.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write the letter big on the board, capital and small. Say the sound each time, not the letter name.
- 2 Say the words on the student page out loud, one at a time. Thumbs up or thumbs down.
- 3 Hand out the page. Point at the tracing rail and trace one in the air together first.
- 4 They trace, then circle the pictures. Say the picture names out loud as they work, because some will not know them.

THE SOUND, NOT THE NAME

Say mmm, not the letter name. At this age the sound is what lets them read; the name comes later and gets in the way now.

If a child is stuck

THEY CANNOT**DO THIS****Hear the sound**

Say the word slowly and stretch the first sound. Stretch it far longer than feels sensible.

Form the letter

Trace it on their back with your finger, then let them trace it on the table, then on paper.

Name the picture

Tell them. It is a vocabulary gap, not a phonics one, and guessing wastes the block.



Teaching Shapes All Around

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Today we are looking at shapes. Here is a circle. Round, no corners. Trace it in the air.

Here is a square. Four sides, all the same, four corners. Count the corners with me.

Here is a triangle. Three sides, three corners.

Now look around this room. Point at something that is a circle. Point at something that is a square.

The thing you are actually teaching

CORNERS, NOT PICTURES

A kindergarten child often thinks a shape has to sit the right way up, so a triangle balanced on a point stops being a triangle. Turn one around while they watch and ask if it is still a triangle. Count the corners again. That is the lesson.

What good looks like

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Names circle, square and triangle in any position	Only names them when they sit the usual way up
Counts the corners to check	Guesses by how the shape looks
Finds a shape in the room	Points at anything at all, which is fine on the first ask. Ask again.

TWO PAGES, IN ORDER

The first math page is done together, out loud. The second is theirs to do at the table. If the block is running long, stop after the first page. Half of it done properly is worth more than both rushed.

Science: Day and Night

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each one before you move on. This is a talking block, not a writing block.

1. The Earth is always turning, slowly, like a very big ball. That is why we have day and night.

Ask: everybody turn around slowly once. That is a day.

2. When our side of the Earth is turned towards the sun, it is day and it is light. When it turns away, it is night and it is dark.

Ask: is the sun still there at night?

3. The moon does not make its own light. The sun shines on it, and it shines back at us. That is why Nell could see it.

Ask: have you ever seen the moon in the daytime?

4. We do different things in the day and at night. We do not choose that by accident. Our bodies get sleepy when it goes dark.

Ask: what is the first thing you do when you wake up?

THEN THE CUT AND SORT

Hand out the sorting page. Cut first, all of them, before anybody glues anything. Then sort. Then glue.

Day: the sun and the ball. Night: the bed and the moon. Accept a child who puts the ball at night if they explain it, because some children play outside after dinner.

What to Look For

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Kindergarten work does not mark like older work. Most of these pages have no right answer, so this page tells you what to look at instead, and what to write on the note back.

The pages with actual answers

PAGE	ANSWER
Letters: Mm	Circle: moon, mouse, map, milk. Not circled: cat, sun, tree, fish.
Math: shapes	Circle, square, triangle, rectangle. Only the circles get colored blue. A child who colors the rectangle has probably heard oblong at home, so ask before correcting.
Afternoon sort	Day: the sun and the ball. Night: the bed and the moon. Accept a child who puts the ball at night if they explain it, because some children play outside after dinner.

The pages with no right answer

PAGE	WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING AT
Morning work	Did they find their name line and have a go? Tracing quality is not the point on a day with a stranger in the room.
After the story	Does the picture come from the story? Ask them about it before deciding it does not.
Writing	One letter is a success. The initial sound is a big success. A whole word is a bonus, not the target.
How Was Today?	The most useful page in the pile. Read these first and leave them on top.

DO NOT CORRECT THE LETTER FORMATION

Backwards letters are developmentally normal at five and stay normal for a while yet. Correcting them in front of a substitute teaches a child that writing is dangerous. Leave it for the class teacher.

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Morning Work

Name: _____

1 Write your name at the top.

2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.

3 Color the picture.

1. Trace and say

man mat me

2. Color me

COLOR THE PICTURE FROM TODAY'S STORY



After the Story

1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Tell somebody about your picture.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



My picture

TALK ABOUT IT

Tell the person next to you what is happening in your picture.

Letter of the Day: Mm

1 Trace the letters.

2 Circle the pictures that start with the sound.

M m M m M m

Circle the ones that start with mmm



moon



cat



mouse



sun



map



tree



milk



fish

FINISHED?

Find one more thing in this room that starts with mmm. Draw it on the back of your sheet.

Draw and Label

1 Draw one thing from the story.

2 Write the first letter underneath.

YOUR PICTURE



What did you draw?

FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

One letter is a success here. If a child writes the first sound of their word, that is exactly where kindergarten writing should be. Do not ask for more, and do not correct what they do write.

Shapes All Around

1 Say the name of each shape.

2 Count the corners with your finger.

3 Color every circle blue.



circle



square



triangle



rectangle

Now find them in the room

SHAPE

I FOUND

A circle

A square

A triangle

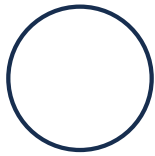


Your Turn

1 Trace the shapes.

2 Draw one more of your own beside it.

circle



YOUR TURN

square



YOUR TURN

triangle



YOUR TURN



Day and Night: Cut and Sort

1 Cut out the four pictures at the bottom.

2 Put each one in the right box.

3 Glue them down when you are sure.

THINGS WE DO IN THE DAY

THINGS WE DO AT NIGHT



sun



bed



ball



moon

FINISHED?

Draw one more thing that would go in either box.

How Was Today?

1 Color the face that shows how today felt.

2 Draw one thing you did today.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name

Day 3 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school bells win. The Page column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. Nothing here runs past twenty, and there is a movement break between almost all of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they trace.	p. 48
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	The story, on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	Talk about it	Turn and talk, then the drawing page at desks.	p. 49
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:50	Letters	Teach the sound, then the tracing page.	p. 50
10:15	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:40	Writing	Draw first, then one word underneath.	p. 51
11:05	Break	Two minutes. They will need it.	back
11:15	Math	Teaching script together, then the two pages.	p. 52
11:55	Lunch	Line them up five minutes early.	—
12:45	Rest time	Books, heads down, or the quiet bank.	back
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud, then the cut and sort.	p. 54
1:50	Choosing time	If there is no special, use the Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 55
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut choosing time and the second math page first. Never cut the movement breaks or the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. They are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everybody. My name is on the board, and I have drawn a little picture next to it so you can find it.

Your teacher is away today and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing.

First, my quiet signal. I clap like this, and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely.

This morning we have a story about ten baby turtles, some letters, and counting all the way to ten. This afternoon we find out what living things need.

You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write your name on the board and draw a small picture beside it. They will remember the picture.
- 2 Teach the clap-back signal. Practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
- 3 Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
- 4 Ask: what does this class always do at carpet time? Take two answers only.
- 5 Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
- 6 Start the story while they are still settled.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.

Read Aloud: Ten Tiny Turtles

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The orange boxes are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

Ten Tiny Turtles

Read-aloud story

Under the warm sand there were ten eggs.

One night the sand moved, and out came ten tiny turtles, no bigger than your thumb.

STOP AND ASK

How many turtles are there? Count with me.

Turtles know one thing when they hatch. They know to go towards the light, because the light means the sea.

Nine turtles turned to the water and went. Flip, flip, flip, across the sand.

One turtle did not.

The tenth turtle saw a different light, a yellow one, far up the beach. And it turned around and went that way instead.

STOP AND ASK

Where do you think the tenth one is going?

It went past a shell. It went past a stick. It went a long, long way, and the sand got drier and drier.

Then a cloud moved.

And the moon came out, all the way out, and it lay across the water like a white road.

The tenth turtle stopped. It turned around. And it followed the moon road all the way down the sand and into the sea, where the other nine were waiting.

Ten tiny turtles. All of them home.

STOP AND ASK

What helped the last turtle find the sea?



Talking About the Story

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Five minutes on the carpet, then send them to tables for the drawing page. Kindergarten comprehension is spoken, not written, so this is where you find out whether the story landed.

Turn and talk, twice

SAY THIS

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them the part you liked best. I will count to twenty and then I want to hear two of them.

Now tell them one thing that happened at the beginning, and one thing that happened at the end.

What to listen for

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Retells one thing that actually happened in the story	Retells a different story, or tells you their own news
Uses a character name	Says "the one" or "him" for everybody
Answers the question that was asked	Answers a question nobody asked, which is very normal at five

The answers you are listening for

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE	
Question 1	Ten. Count the turtles on your fingers together and hold up all ten at the end.
Question 2	Open. Somebody will say the wrong way, and that is the point of the question.
Question 3	The moon on the water. Accept the light, and say the moon out loud so everybody has it.

THEN SEND THEM TO TABLES

The drawing page comes next. Say it before you move: "Draw the part you liked best. One picture. You do not have to write anything."

A child who draws something not in the story has still listened. Ask them about it before you decide otherwise.

Teaching Tt

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Today our sound is Tt. Watch my mouth. t.

Now you. t. Again, longer. t.

Put your hand in front of your mouth and say it again. Can you feel it?

Now I am going to say some words. Put your thumb up if the word starts with t.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write the letter big on the board, capital and small. Say the sound each time, not the letter name.
- 2 Say the words on the student page out loud, one at a time. Thumbs up or thumbs down.
- 3 Hand out the page. Point at the tracing rail and trace one in the air together first.
- 4 They trace, then circle the pictures. Say the picture names out loud as they work, because some will not know them.

THE SOUND, NOT THE NAME

Say t, not the letter name. At this age the sound is what lets them read; the name comes later and gets in the way now.

If a child is stuck

THEY CANNOT	DO THIS
Hear the sound	Say the word slowly and stretch the first sound. Stretch it far longer than feels sensible.
Form the letter	Trace it on their back with your finger, then let them trace it on the table, then on paper.
Name the picture	Tell them. It is a vocabulary gap, not a phonics one, and guessing wastes the block.



Teaching Counting to Ten

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Hold up your fingers and count with me. One, two, three, all the way to ten.

Now I am going to count some things on the board, and I want you to catch me if I get it wrong.

Count them slowly, touching each one. Then count the same group again but deliberately count one twice, and let them catch you.

That is the whole lesson. When you count, you touch each thing once. One touch, one number.

The thing you are actually teaching

ONE TOUCH, ONE NUMBER

The skill is one to one correspondence: touching each object exactly once as you say each number. A child who chants to ten perfectly but double counts the objects has not got it yet, and that child is the reason this block exists.

What good looks like

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Counts and touches each one once	Says numbers faster than the finger moves, or skips one
Says the last number when asked how many	Recounts from one every time you ask
Writes the number, even wobbly or backwards	Cannot start. Trace it with them once, then let go.

TWO PAGES, IN ORDER

The first math page is done together, out loud. The second is theirs to do at the table. If the block is running long, stop after the first page. Half of it done properly is worth more than both rushed.

Science: What Living Things Need

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each one before you move on. This is a talking block, not a writing block.

1. Living things grow, need food and water, and make more of themselves. A turtle is living. So are you.

Ask: name three living things you can see right now.

2. A plant is living too, even though it does not run about. It grows, it drinks, and it makes seeds.

Ask: is a tree living? How do you know?

3. Living things need food, water, air and somewhere safe to be. Take any one of those away and they cannot manage.

Ask: what do you think a baby turtle needs first?

4. Some things were never alive at all. A rock. A ball. A spoon. They never grew and they never needed anything.

Ask: is a car alive? It moves and it drinks fuel. Why not?

THEN THE CUT AND SORT

Hand out the sorting page. Cut first, all of them, before anybody glues anything. Then sort. Then glue.

Needs food and water: the turtle and the tree. Needs nothing: the ball and the house. The tree is the one that splits a class, and the argument is worth having.

What to Look For

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Kindergarten work does not mark like older work. Most of these pages have no right answer, so this page tells you what to look at instead, and what to write on the note back.

The pages with actual answers

PAGE	ANSWER
Letters: Tt	Circle: turtle, tree, ten, table. Not circled: sun, moon, cat, cup.
Math: counting	Ten frames show 7, 4 and 10. On the second page any drawing that matches the number is correct.
Afternoon sort	Needs food and water: the turtle and the tree. Needs nothing: the ball and the house. The tree is the one that splits a class, and the argument is worth having.

The pages with no right answer

PAGE	WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING AT
Morning work	Did they find their name line and have a go? Tracing quality is not the point on a day with a stranger in the room.
After the story	Does the picture come from the story? Ask them about it before deciding it does not.
Writing	One letter is a success. The initial sound is a big success. A whole word is a bonus, not the target.
How Was Today?	The most useful page in the pile. Read these first and leave them on top.

DO NOT CORRECT THE LETTER FORMATION

Backwards letters are developmentally normal at five and stay normal for a while yet. Correcting them in front of a substitute teaches a child that writing is dangerous. Leave it for the class teacher.

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Morning Work

Name: _____

1 Write your name at the top.

2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.

3 Color the picture.

1. Trace and say

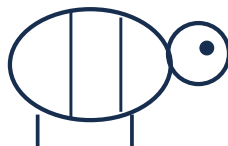
top

ten

to

2. Color me

COLOR THE PICTURE FROM TODAY'S STORY



After the Story

1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Tell somebody about your picture.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



My picture

TALK ABOUT IT

Tell the person next to you what is happening in your picture.

Letter of the Day: Tt

1 Trace the letters.

2 Circle the pictures that start with the sound.

T t T t T t

Circle the ones that start with t



turtle



sun



tree



moon



ten



cat



cup



table

FINISHED?

Find one more thing in this room that starts with t. Draw it on the back of your sheet.

Draw and Label

1 Draw one thing from the story.

2 Write the first letter underneath.

YOUR PICTURE



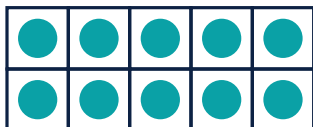
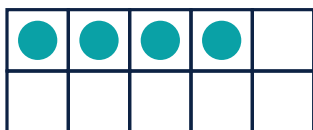
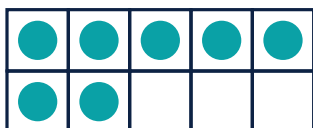
What did you draw?

FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

One letter is a success here. If a child writes the first sound of their word, that is exactly where kindergarten writing should be. Do not ask for more, and do not correct what they do write.

Counting to Ten

- 1 Count the circles out loud.
- 2 Touch each one as you say the number.
- 3 Write how many in the box.



Your Turn

1 Trace the numbers.

2 Draw that many circles in the box.

6

7

8

9

10

6



7



8



What Living Things Need: Cut and Sort

1 Cut out the four pictures at the bottom.

2 Put each one in the right box.

3 Glue them down when you are sure.

NEEDS FOOD AND WATER

DOES NOT NEED ANYTHING



turtle



tree



ball



house

FINISHED?

Draw one more thing that would go in either box.

How Was Today?

1 Color the face that shows how today felt.

2 Draw one thing you did today.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name

Time Filler Bank

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE. YOU WILL NEED IT.

WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS

A kindergarten day is mostly gaps: five minutes before a special, ten because lunch ran late, the eternity while twenty five year olds put their coats on. Those gaps are where a class you do not know falls apart. Nothing below needs any equipment at all.

Under three minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
Simon says	Never fails at this age. Speed it up to make it harder. You can play it in a line waiting for the bell.
Copy my clap	You clap a rhythm, they clap it back. Make it longer each time. Doubles as your quiet signal.
Head, shoulders, knees	Sing it. Then faster. Then missing out one body part.
Sleeping bunnies	Everybody curls up asleep. You wake them one table at a time. Buys you a genuinely calm two minutes.
I spy with sounds	Use the first sound, not the letter name. "I spy something starting with mmm." That makes it phonics.
Five finger counting	Hold up fingers, they call the number. Then you call, they hold up.

Three to ten minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
The rhyming game	You say a word, they add rhymes around the circle. Made-up words are allowed and make it funnier.
What is missing?	Put four things on a table. They close their eyes. Take one away. What has gone?
Story chain	You start with one sentence. Each child adds one. Absurd is fine and usually better.
Guess my animal	You think of one. They ask yes or no questions. Cap it at ten and count them out loud.
Number of the day	Pick a number under ten. They say everything they know about it: one more, one less, on fingers.
Freeze dance, no music	You clap a beat, they move. You stop, they freeze. Needs nothing.

TWO RULES FOR ANY OF THESE

Say how it ends before it starts, and do not offer a choice. Pick one, announce it, run it. Asking twenty five year olds what they would like to play turns a calm five minutes into a difficult fifteen.

Brain Breaks and Transitions

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

USE ONE EVERY FIFTEEN MINUTES, NOT WHEN IT GOES WRONG

A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. A break every fifteen minutes is not lost time. It is what buys you the next fifteen.

Signs you needed one five minutes ago: chairs tipping, three bathroom requests in a row, or the same question asked twice.

At their tables, one minute

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Ten and ten	Ten shoulder rolls back, ten forward. Everyone stays seated.
Sky and toes	Reach to the sky for five, touch your toes for five. Three times.
Five big breaths	In through the nose for four, out through the mouth for six. Genuinely calms a room before writing.
Cross-body taps	Right hand to left knee, left hand to right knee, twenty times. Crossing the midline really does help.
Finger stretches	Spread, squeeze, spread, squeeze. Do it before every writing block, not after.

Standing up, two to three minutes

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Animal moves	Hop like a frog, stretch like a cat, stomp like an elephant. Ten seconds each. They will suggest more.
Four corners	Name the corners one to four. Call a number, everyone moves. Call them faster.
Popcorn	Everybody crouches. You call names and each child pops up and back down. Speed up.
Follow the leader	You lead a march around the room and back to the carpet. Excellent for moving a class without a queue.
Shake it out	Shake one hand for eight, other hand for eight, one foot, other foot. Then four, then two, then one.

GETTING THEM BACK

Always say how it ends before it starts. "When I clap twice we are sitting down ready." A break without a stated ending is just noise you now have to fix.

Wet Weather Bank

SUBSTITUTE • FOR THE DAY IT RAINS

INDOOR RECESS IS THE HARDEST PART OF A KINDERGARTEN COVER DAY

They expect free time, you do not know the rules, and the room is not built for it. Pick one activity, announce it clearly, and run it for the whole period. Offering choices is what turns wet play into chaos.

Whole class, no equipment

GAME	HOW IT WORKS
Sleeping lions	Everyone lies still. You walk around. Anyone who moves or giggles sits up and helps you spot the others. Buys you fifteen quiet minutes and they never tire of it.
Heads down, thumbs up	Four children are chosen. Everyone else puts heads down, thumb up. The four each press one thumb.
The copying game	One child leaves. The class picks a leader who starts actions everyone copies. The detective works out who.
Corners	Number the corners. Call a number. Anyone in that corner sits down. Last standing wins.
Musical statues, no music	You clap, they dance. You stop, they freeze. Out means helping you spot the next one.

At tables, quieter

- Draw your bedroom from above, looking down. Harder and more absorbing than it sounds.
- Roll and draw. No dice? They pick a number one to six and you call one out. Each number is a body part to add to a monster.
- Name that pattern. Draw a repeating pattern on the board and they copy it and continue it.
- Partner drawing. One child draws a shape, the partner turns it into a picture.

TWO RULES TO STATE AT THE START

Everyone stays in the room, and when you clap the game stops instantly. Say both before you start, not after something goes wrong.

Choosing Time Menu

COPY THIS PAGE FOR CHILDREN, OR READ IT OUT

1 Pick any box.

2 You do not need to ask.

TRY THIS

- 1 Draw your favorite animal. Give it a name.
- 2 Draw a picture of the story we read today. Put yourself in it.
- 3 Find five things in the room that are round. Draw them.
- 4 Count how many chairs are in the room. Count again to check.
- 5 Write your name as big as the whole page.
- 6 Draw a machine that would tidy your bedroom for you.
- 7 Draw what you will do after school.
- 8 Draw something you are good at.

SPACE TO WORK

STILL FINISHED?

Look at a book quietly, or help someone at your table. Helping means asking them a question, not doing it for them.

Substitute's Note Back

SUBSTITUTE • FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU LEAVE

THREE THINGS, THEN YOU ARE DONE

1. Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top.
2. Name two or three children who genuinely helped. Teachers act on this and the children find out.
3. Write one line about anything the teacher should know. One line.

NOTE BACK TO THE TEACHER

My name

Day taught

Day 1 / Day 2 / Day 3

We got through

All of it / Most of it / The morning only

What we did not reach

Children who helped

Anyone upset or unwell

Toileting or clothes

The line the teacher most needs

Anything else

One line is plenty

Would I come back?

Yes, gladly / Yes / Probably not, because:

A NOTE TO THE RETURNING TEACHER

The most useful thing in the pile is not the worksheets. It is the stack of How Was Today? sheets, where each child has colored a face and drawn one thing they did. Read those first. They take four minutes and they will tell you more about the day than any of the work.

Standards Alignment

COMMON CORE AND NGSS • KINDERGARTEN

Each block is mapped to its primary standard. These are complete instructional days, not curriculum coverage, and every day stands alone.

DAY	BLOCK	FOCUS	STANDARD
1	Read aloud	Listening, prediction, retell	RL.K.1, RL.K.2, SL.K.2
1	Letters	Initial sound Ss, letter formation	RF.K.1.d, RF.K.3.a, L.K.1.a
1	Writing	Draw and label with an initial sound	W.K.2, L.K.2.c
1	Math	Counting to five, one to one correspondence	K.CC.B.4, K.CC.B.5
1	Science	How animals move	K-LS1-1
2	Read aloud	Problem and solution, character	RL.K.1, RL.K.3, SL.K.2
2	Letters	Initial sound Mm, letter formation	RF.K.1.d, RF.K.3.a
2	Writing	Draw and label with an initial sound	W.K.2
2	Math	Identifying and describing 2D shapes	K.G.A.2, K.G.B.4
2	Science	Day and night, patterns in the sky	K-ESS2-1
3	Read aloud	Counting within a story, cause and effect	RL.K.1, SL.K.1
3	Letters	Initial sound Tt, letter formation	RF.K.1.d, RF.K.3.a
3	Writing	Draw and label with an initial sound	W.K.2
3	Math	Counting to ten, writing numerals	K.CC.A.3, K.CC.B.4, K.CC.B.5
3	Science	What living things need	K-LS1-1, K-ESS3-1

Also practiced every day

- Letter formation, through the tracing rails on every morning and letters page
- Counting and number recognition, through the ten frames
- Speaking and listening, through the carpet discussion and turn and talk prompts
- Self-assessment, through the How Was Today? sheet

A NOTE ON STANDARDS

These are designed to be genuinely useful on a day the regular teacher is absent, without depending on where a class has reached in its own program.

This resource is independently created and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or reviewed by any state agency or standards body.

Terms of Use and Credits

THANK YOU

Thank you for buying this pack. It was written by a practicing teacher with more than twenty years in classrooms, and built the way I would want a full day of kindergarten cover built if I were the one waking up sick at half past five.

If it saved you a morning, a rating genuinely helps other teachers find it, and earns you credit toward your next purchase.

Getting the most out of this pack

- Print all three days before you need them. The whole point is that it works on a morning when you cannot get to school.
- Copy each day as one stapled packet. Eight student pages. Handing out separate sheets all day is where a kindergarten class comes apart.
- Keep the eight substitute pages in order on the desk.
- Fill in the Class Information page once, at the start of the year.
- Use the filler banks when you are present too. The brain breaks work on any Tuesday.

Terms of use

You may: print this pack for your own classroom, as many times as you like, for as many years as you like. Photocopy the student pages freely for your own children and leave the pack for a substitute covering your own class.

You may not: share the file with colleagues, upload it to a school drive, district server, or any public website, resell it, or claim it as your own work. Additional licenses for colleagues are available at a discount on the listing page.

All stories, tasks, questions and answer keys in this pack are original works written for this resource and are copyright of the author. No third-party copyrighted material is reproduced anywhere in this pack.

ALSO FROM DIGITAL VECTOR

Full-Day Sub Plans, Grades 1-2, Volumes 1 and 2. Six complete days built around a read-aloud.

Full-Day Sub Plans, Grades 3-5, Volumes 1 and 2. Six complete days for older elementary classes.

Emergency Sub Plans for Middle School Science, Math, ELA and Computer Science.

Credits

Written, designed and typeset by Clarence Goh. Set in Lato and JetBrains Mono.

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